

A COLD WAR STRATEGY GAME

W.A.C.K.

STRATEGIC COMMAND SYSTEM

THE PLAYER'S HANDBOOK



The warning is uncertain. The decision is yours.

START HERE

THE WORLD IS WAITING.

A warning appears. Another report disagrees. Your advisers see different risks. Somewhere between a false alarm and a real attack, you must decide what to do next.

What kind of game is this?

W.A.C.K. is a Cold War command-room strategy game. You read incoming reports, weigh advice and issue orders as a military crisis unfolds. The computer presents information; you make the decisions.

What am I trying to do?

Manage the crisis without losing control of it. Decide when to seek better evidence, when to hold back and when to act. Your choices shape what happens next and the outcome you reach.

This is about judgment, not fast clicking. You do not need military knowledge to begin. Read the explanation beside an order before committing to it.

Your desk, at a glance

SITUATION

Your next decision.

STAFF

Advice to weigh.

AUTHORITY

Approval to check.

EVIDENCE

Reports to examine.

PACKAGES

Responses to compare.

RECORD

Decisions to revisit.

GETTING STARTED

YOUR FIRST DECISION

01 Enter the command room

Open the game and choose START NEW CAMPAIGN. Let the startup checks finish, then choose CONTINUE CAMPAIGN.

02 Find out what is happening

In SITUATION, read CURRENT DECISION. Visit EVIDENCE to inspect the reports and STAFF to hear advice. Reading rooms does not spend a turn.

03 Choose an order – but do not rush

Return to SITUATION. Select an option and choose REVIEW SELECTED ORDER. Read its effect and whether it advances the crisis.

04 Confirm, then see what changed

Choose CONFIRM ORDER when ready, or RETURN TO OPTIONS to reconsider. After confirming, read SINCE YOUR LAST ORDER. Repeat as new decisions arrive.

A useful way to think

If two reports disagree, compare them before accepting either as certain. You are deciding what evidence justifies an action, not guessing which button the game wants.

PLAY IN YOUR BROWSER

`peteconnorctg.github.io/wack-strategic-command`

QUICK REFERENCE

WHEN THE CRISIS DEEPENS

What does DEFCON mean?

It is the alert level: 5 is lowest, 1 is highest. It shows escalation, not your score.

Will this action spend a turn?

READ means inspect information. PROCEDURE may update the command record. Neither spends a strategic turn. A STRATEGIC ORDER advances the crisis when you confirm it.

Why is release authorization asking me to check?

Approval must match the current plan. Check for changed details, missing confirmation or a HOLD. Use the available recheck actions. KEEP HOLD - INSPECT EVIDENCE lets you investigate without lifting the hold.

How do I follow an exchange?

The map shows the results of your orders. Use PAUSE / RESUME to slow down, PREVIOUS / NEXT EVENT to step through, or REPLAY LAST EVENT to watch again. SHOW RESOLVED STATE skips to the current result.

Playback does not spend turns or undo events. Make your next decision when new orders are available.

Can I stop and come back?

Wait for ORDER RECORDED - GAME SAVED before closing. Return in the same browser and choose CONTINUE CAMPAIGN. RESUME BRIEF helps you pick up where you left off.

Avoid private browsing. Clearing site data can erase your save; progress does not transfer automatically between devices.